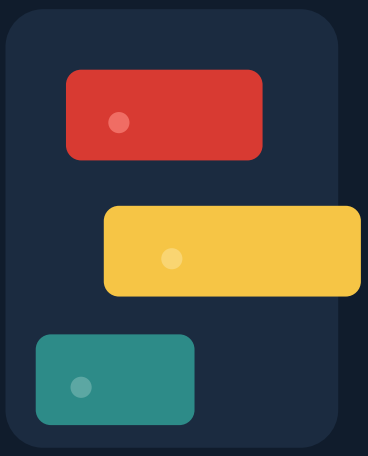
INDEPENDENT STRATEGIC RESEARCH & CASE STUDY



SOCIAL COMMERCE STRATEGY

LEGO

Community-led discovery, creator content,
conversion architecture and commerce measurement

BUSINESS / CASE

The LEGO Group - international toy and creative-play brand

ROLE

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PORTFOLIO SERIES DATE

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BENCHMARK / SOURCE REFRESH

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Independent analysis. Recommendations are proposed opportunities, not LEGO Group-endorsed plans.

01 / DECISION SUMMARY

Executive brief

The opportunity is not simply to make products shoppable on social platforms. It is to connect creative discovery, community validation, product understanding and reliable checkout into one measurable system.

Make the community part of the commerce engine - not just the audience for the ad.

Strategic thesis: help people imagine the build, see credible proof, choose the right set, and complete a low-friction purchase wherever checkout is supported.

01 DISCOVERY
Use short-form builds, satisfying transformations, creator demonstrations and theme-specific storytelling to earn qualified attention.

02 VALIDATION
Use fan builds, reviews, product details, set comparisons and community proof to reduce uncertainty.

03 CONVERSION
Route each market to the best supported path: brand product page, retailer, or approved commerce feature.

What the evidence supports

- LEGO Ideas makes fan participation a visible product-discovery and validation mechanism: ideas can be supported by the community and may be considered for production at the 10,000-supporter milestone or through challenges. [1]
- LEGO reported DKK 83.5 billion in 2025 revenue and DKK 22.0 billion in operating profit. This demonstrates business scale, but it does not disclose the impact of social commerce on sales. [2]
- McKinsey reported that social media product research averaged 32% in its surveyed markets in 2025, compared with 27% in 2023. This is evidence of a shifting research habit, not a universal global rate. [3]
- TikTok Shop is not listed as available in Bangladesh in the platform help page reviewed for this report. Bangladesh-based plans should not assume in-app checkout is available. [4]

Strategic decision

Build a community-to-commerce pathway first; choose native in-app checkout only where the platform, market, product and account are eligible. Measure the quality and economics of completed orders, not views alone.

Scope note: This report is an independent external case analysis. It does not claim access to LEGO internal social analytics, conversion data, campaign costs, or confidential plans. All proposed tactics are recommendations; all sample campaign numbers later in the report are illustrative.

Business context and evidence

Separate public facts from strategic interpretation. The distinction protects credibility and prevents a portfolio case from implying inside access.

Publicly verifiable context

RESEARCH AREA	WHAT PUBLIC EVIDENCE SAYS
Brand / product context	LEGO offers product themes across age groups and interests. Its official shop combines theme, age, price range, occasion and product-discovery pathways. [1][5]
Community mechanism	LEGO Ideas invites fan-submitted product ideas. A project reaching 10,000 supporters may enter review; selection is not guaranteed. [1]
Business scale	The 2025 Annual Report lists revenue of DKK 83.5bn and operating profit of DKK 22.0bn. These are corporate financial results, not social-commerce performance metrics. [2]
Digital capability	The 2025 report describes ongoing work on digital foundations, lifecycle systems, shopper and membership platforms, security, and marketing activation tools. [2]

Category-level signal: discovery is becoming social

McKINSEY - 2025
Across its surveyed markets, social media use for product research averaged 32%, versus 27% in 2023. The report also notes roughly half of surveyed Indian consumers research products on social media before purchase. The country, sample and survey wording matter. [3]

META / GWI - INDIA
A Meta-commissioned retail study reported that nearly 8 in 10 Indian shoppers discover products through social media. Use this as an India-specific directional signal, not a global forecast or a guaranteed LEGO result. [6]

Strategic interpretation

- LEGO has an unusually rich raw material for social commerce: the product is visual, demonstrable, remixable, and naturally generates build-progress content.
- Fan participation should serve both brand value and decision support. A build post can inspire, while an honest review, parts/size demonstration or theme comparison can help a buyer decide.
- No public source cited here proves that a particular LEGO platform or post causes sales. Test recommendations against tracked visits, orders and contribution economics before scaling.

Research confidence labels

LABEL	HOW TO READ IT
PUBLIC FACT	Directly supported by an official LEGO or platform source.
MARKET SIGNAL	Third-party or platform-sponsored survey; directional and limited by market/sample.
STRATEGIC HYPOTHESIS	Reasoned recommendation to validate through controlled testing.
ILLUSTRATIVE DATA	Invented example used to demonstrate analysis; not reported company performance.

Audience strategy and purchase journey

Treat audiences as groups with different jobs-to-be-done, not simply broad age and interest buckets.

Priority segments

SEGMENT	PURCHASE MOTIVATION / ANXIETY	CONTENT THAT REDUCES FRICTION
Adult fans and collectors	Identity, display value, theme affinity, build complexity, exclusivity, community recognition.	Detailed reveals, display shots, build time, piece count, reviews, fan creations.
Parents and gift buyers	Age suitability, value, play opportunity, difficulty, delivery timing, safety and gift confidence.	Gift guides, age/skill explanations, what-is-in-the-box, play ideas, delivery/returns answers.
Creative builders and hobbyists	Challenge, technique, customization, inspiration, sharing, learning.	Build tutorials, time-lapse, alternate builds, expert walkthroughs, creator challenges.
Licensed-theme fans	Connection to a story or character, visual fidelity, collectability, set details.	Reference details, comparison clips, close-ups, launch explainers, availability alerts.

Map content to the real journey

STAGE	CONTENT / EXPERIENCE	MEASURE
1. DISCOVER	Stop-scroll build transformation, satisfying assembly, creator reaction.	Qualified video views, reach, saves, shares.
2. VALIDATE	Reviews, fan builds, expert opinions, community discussion.	Product-detail clicks, engaged visits, branded search, quality comments.
3. COMPARE	Theme or set comparison, size-in-context, difficulty, piece count and price clarity.	Product-page depth, comparison clicks, add-to-cart.
4. PURCHASE	Clear availability, trusted seller, delivery, returns and checkout information.	Checkout start, purchase CVR, CPA, contribution after marketing.
5. SHARE / RETURN	Build showcase, follow-up ideas, community prompts and related set discovery.	Repeat purchase, customer content, referrals, opt-in retention.

Operating principle

A person who watches a 20-second build reveal is not automatically ready to buy. Discovery content earns attention; comparison content answers questions; trust content reduces risk; conversion content makes the next step obvious. Avoid forcing every post to carry the same sales message.

Child-safety guardrail: Because the brand serves children as well as adults, paid targeting, creator casting, community prompts and data collection require careful age, privacy and safeguarding review. Prefer parent/caregiver purchase journeys and do not design tactics that exploit children or collect unnecessary child data. [2]

04 / CHANNEL ARCHITECTURE

Commerce architecture and platform fit

The platform should play a defined role in the journey. The right conversion destination depends on market eligibility, inventory and customer expectations.

LAYER	DESIGN REQUIREMENT
SOCIAL DISCOVERY	Short-form video, carousels, livestream or creator post. Show the finished experience and the reason to care.
PROOF + PRODUCT INFO	Creator demonstration, product detail, official page, review, community discussion and accurate specifications.
ROUTED CHECKOUT	Eligible native shop OR official brand site OR verified retailer. Use a market-specific link and track the route.
POST-PURCHASE LOOP	Build prompt, accessory/related-theme discovery, opt-in email or membership, and customer creation rights.

Recommended platform roles

CHANNEL / ASSET	PRIMARY JOB
Instagram	Visual discovery, Reels, carousel explainers, community proof, creator partnerships and profile-to-product routes. Verify available commerce features by market/account.
TikTok	Fast demonstrations, creator-led review, trend-aware discovery and live/video shopping where officially available. As reviewed in October 2026, TikTok Shop availability list does not include Bangladesh. [4]
YouTube	Longer builds, expert reviews, comparisons and high-consideration product explanations; cut vertical highlights for discovery.
Facebook / communities	Adult fan groups, gift-oriented discovery, event discussions and service questions. Use approved community norms and avoid spammy selling.
LEGO.com / retailers	Product truth, availability, price, shipping, returns, product variants and checkout. These owned or verified destinations should close the loop.
LEGO Ideas	Co-creation and idea validation; a source of stories and feedback, not a guarantee that a fan idea becomes a product. [1]

Native checkout is a capability, not a strategy

TikTok Shop currently lists Brazil, France, Indonesia, Ireland, Italy, Japan, Malaysia, Mexico, the Philippines, Singapore, Spain, Thailand, the United Kingdom, the United States and Vietnam. Bangladesh is not on that list. Features and eligibility can change, so re-check the official country and account guidance before every launch. [4]

For Bangladesh-focused work: plan a social-to-website or social-to-verified-retailer route, or messaging-assisted sales only where the operation can answer questions, confirm stock, protect data and fulfil orders reliably. Do not present WhatsApp or DMs as a scalable checkout substitute without service-level design.

05 / CREATIVE SYSTEM

Content and creator commerce system

Build an asset engine that gives audiences different kinds of evidence at different decision stages. Prioritise reusable content with clear product and audience fit.

ASSET FORMAT	CREATIVE BRIEF	ROLE
BUILD REVEAL	0-3 second hook: pieces become a recognizable object, display or scene.	Discovery / desire
DETAILS THAT MATTER	Size-in-context, piece count, build complexity, finished model, moving parts and box contents.	Compare / qualify
CREATOR TEST	Expert builder or adult collector explains what surprised them, who the set suits and trade-offs.	Trust / evaluation
COMMUNITY SPOTLIGHT	Fan creation, alternate build, behind-the-build story or challenge highlight with explicit permissions.	Belonging / proof
GIFT DECISION GUIDE	Help a buyer select by budget, age recommendation, interest, display space and time available.	Decision / conversion
AFTER-PURCHASE IDEA	Show a new way to display, rebuild or extend the play experience; invite optional sharing.	Retention / advocacy

Creator selection: fit before follower count

- Audience alignment: Is the creator’s audience composed of adult fans, parents, gift buyers, hobbyists or licensed-theme fans relevant to the set?
- Demonstration quality: Can they explain the build and show detail honestly, without relying entirely on hype?
- Commercial reliability: Review prior sponsored content, comment quality, brand safety, response discipline and measurable click behaviour.
- Rights and disclosure: Document usage term, channels, paid amplification, edits, whitelisting/authorization, exclusivity, compensation, disclosure and permission to reuse fan-submitted work.
- Safety: Set extra guardrails for any content involving children, family creators or child-facing communities.

Testable creative hypotheses

ID	TEST	HYPOTHESIS
A	Transformation-first hook	A satisfying reveal earns more qualified product-page visits than a static pack shot.
B	Expert review vs. brand voice	An adult builder’s considered review may help high-consideration buyers evaluate fit.
C	Decision guide vs. discount-first	Helpful set selection may improve qualified conversion while protecting price integrity.
D	Product page route vs. retailer route	The best destination varies by stock, delivery promise, price and checkout friction.

Creative production rule

One creative should test one primary idea at a time. Keep audience, offer, landing page and reporting window comparable when possible. A high-view video is a candidate for further analysis, not automatically a winning sales asset.

06 / CONVERSION EXPERIENCE

Conversion design: from interest to order

Social commerce underperforms when product content creates desire but the destination leaves basic questions unanswered. Audit the full click path, not just the post.

FRICTION	BUYER QUESTION	STRATEGIC RESPONSE
Product clarity	What exactly is included? What are the dimensions, piece count, age/skill guidance and key features?	Show the set in context; keep specs accurate and consistent across social, product page and retailer.
Availability	Can the buyer actually purchase this item in their country and preferred store? Is stock current?	Link to a local, verified destination; label out-of-stock or preorder status.
Trust	Is the creator sponsored? Is the seller reputable? Are photos, reviews and promises credible?	Disclose partnerships; moderate claims; use authentic reviews and official seller links.
Checkout	Are shipping cost, delivery dates, return policy and payment expectations clear before checkout?	Reduce surprise costs and unnecessary steps; test mobile speed and link integrity.
Choice overload	Which set is right for this person, budget, age recommendation and interest?	Use theme/budget/interest selectors and short comparison content rather than a giant product dump.
After purchase	What should the customer do next? How can they return, build, share or discover another set?	Use opt-in follow-up, build inspiration, service help and related-product recommendations without pressure.

Suggested product-page checklist

- The social post and destination describe the same set, version, price and availability.
- Images include a clear product view plus at least one credible scale/context cue.
- Key specifications, intended age/skill guidance, inventory, delivery, returns and seller identity are easy to find.
- Reviews and creator claims are authentic, properly disclosed, and not presented as proof of universal outcomes.
- Mobile product page loads reliably, cart/checkout functions, tracking events fire correctly, and source links use consistent UTM rules.
- An out-of-stock, broken-link or unsupported-market route has a documented fallback.

> Conversion rule: Fix the largest friction point before increasing spend. If product-page visits are healthy but purchases are weak, adding reach may only buy more drop-offs. Diagnose availability, offer fit, page clarity, shipping surprise, checkout problems and audience quality first.

07 / IMPLEMENTATION

30-day activation roadmap

A first month should build reliable foundations, launch a small set of deliberate tests, and make a defensible scale / pause decision.

WHEN	WORKSTREAM	ACTIONS	EXIT CRITERIA
WEEK 1	**Audit and instrument**	Map priority products, local inventory and authorized destinations. Audit social profiles, product pages, shipping/returns and customer questions. Define one primary business objective. Confirm tracking, UTM convention and purchase-event quality.	Baseline funnel; list of broken paths; agreed KPI definitions and owners.
WEEK 2	**Produce and prepare**	Create 4-6 creative angles across reveal, product-detail, creator review and gift/interest guide. Brief adult creators, confirm usage rights and disclosures. Build local landing/product links and answer templates for common questions.	Approved asset bank; destination QA; creator permissions; baseline content calendar.
WEEK 3	**Launch controlled tests**	Publish organic content in a planned sequence. Test small paid distribution only where tracking and stock are reliable. Compare creative concepts, not ten variables at once. Use a consistent reporting window.	Early quality signals; click quality; landing-page behaviour; technical issue log.
WEEK 4	**Diagnose and decide**	Compare performance by audience intent, creative and destination. Review assisted behaviour and delayed conversions where data allows. Improve the weakest journey step. Scale only if economics and fulfilment support it.	Decision memo: scale, iterate, pause or gather more data; next 30-day test plan.

Operating cadence

CADENCE	REVIEW
Daily	Check stock/price/links, comments requiring service, active creator posts and broken tracking.
Twice weekly	Review creative signal, audience comments/questions and landing-page friction. Do not overreact to small samples.
Weekly	Review full funnel, cost per order, estimated contribution after marketing, stock constraints and next tests.
End of month	Write a one-page executive decision: outcome, evidence, limitations, budget implications and owner/date for next action.

Owners to name before launch

Strategy owner; product/inventory owner; creative producer; creator/rights contact; ecommerce or retailer contact; customer support; analytics/tracking owner; budget approver. One person may cover multiple roles in a small team, but responsibility must not remain implicit.

Launch gate: do not begin a conversion test if the product is not available, tracking is unverified, destination is broken, creator rights are unclear, or the team cannot fulfil and support the demand it is paying to create.

Measurement system and illustrative dashboard

Make every metric answer a decision question. Reach is context; completed orders and contribution economics determine whether the system is creating business value.

LAYER	METRICS	DECISION QUESTION
Discovery	Qualified reach, 3-second/meaningful views, completion, saves, shares, creator audience fit.	Which story earns attention from the right people?
Consideration	Product-detail clicks, engaged sessions, product-page depth, branded search, set comparisons.	Does attention produce real product interest?
Conversion	Add-to-cart, checkout start, purchase conversion rate, cost per order, revenue per session.	Where do qualified shoppers abandon?
Economics	Average order value, return/refund rate, estimated contribution margin, new-vs-repeat split, break-even ROAS.	Does growth create contribution after variable costs and marketing?
Retention / advocacy	Repeat purchase, opted-in retention, referral, customer content with permission, support issues.	Does the experience create future value and trust?

Illustrative campaign snapshot - fictional numbers only

MEASURE	VALUE	INTERPRETATION
Impressions	**500,000**	Delivery volume only; not proof of sales.
Product landing sessions	**12,000**	2.4% sessions per impression; depends on deduplication and attribution setup.
Add-to-cart	**840**	7.0% of sessions. Investigate product interest and cart clarity.
Checkout starts	**420**	50.0% of add-to-carts start checkout.
Orders	**252**	60.0% of checkout starts complete; 2.1% of landing sessions order.
Average order value	**$95**	Example value for calculation, not a LEGO price or reported result.
Revenue attributed	**$23,940**	252 x $95. Attribution is not proof of incremental sales.
Campaign cost	**$12,000**	Hypothetical paid media + creator/production cost.

Attributed ROAS	**1.995x (~2.0x)**	**Contribution at 40% margin**	**$9,576**
Contribution less campaign cost	-$2,424 before overhead	Break-even ROAS at 40% contribution margin	**2.5x**

Calculation: attributed revenue / campaign cost = $23,940 / $12,000 = 1.995x. If 40% of revenue remains as contribution before campaign costs, $23,940 x 0.40 = $9,576; less $12,000 cost = -$2,424 before overhead. Simplified break-even ROAS = 1 / 0.40 = 2.5x. Actual decisions need returns, discounts, retailer margins, taxes, fulfilment, repeat purchase, attribution window and incrementality.

09 / DECISION FRAMEWORK

Governance, risks and strategic recommendations

Protect customer trust and operating quality while testing commerce. A social campaign can succeed in platform metrics and still fail commercially or reputationally.

RISK	FAILURE MODE	CONTROL
Unsupported commerce features	Buyer cannot check out in market/account; campaign sends traffic to a dead end.	Verify market, account and product eligibility; route to a tested local site/retailer; re-check platform guidance.
Stock / fulfilment mismatch	Viral demand creates out-of-stock issues, delivery complaints and refunds.	Set a stock threshold, delivery capacity and campaign pause rule before increasing spend.
Creator rights ambiguity	Content reused in paid ads without sufficient authorization or clear terms.	Written usage rights, term, paid-media permission, edits, disclosure and approval workflow. [7]
Vanity-metric bias	Views and engagement look positive while orders or contribution stay weak.	Use full-funnel measurement; evaluate new customers, contribution and incremental lift where possible.
Child safety / privacy	Tactics involve children, data collection or community participation without appropriate safeguards.	Prioritize caregiver journeys; minimize data; review safeguarding and local legal requirements. [2]
Overclaiming product value	Creator exaggerates contents, benefits or availability.	Fact-check product claims and disclose paid relationships; preserve creator voice without inaccurate claims.

Prioritised recommendations

1. Start with a single segment and product cluster.

Pick a small range with reliable stock, clear audience fit and a specific customer question to solve.

2. Build a community-to-product route.

Use fan builds and creator demonstrations to inspire; send interested users to an accurate product page or verified retailer.

3. Design content for decision quality.

Pair spectacle with practical detail: size, pieces, age guidance, difficulty, value, availability and who the set suits.

4. Instrument before paying to scale.

Validate UTM parameters, landing sessions, add-to-cart and purchase events. Reconcile platform reporting with site/retailer data where possible.

5. Scale against contribution, not attributed ROAS alone.

Estimate variable margin, refunds and costs; compare results with a break-even threshold and, where feasible, a holdout or incrementality test.

6. Treat creators as both creative partners and measurable distribution.

Set audience-fit criteria, disclosure, usage rights, tracking links or codes, reporting windows and a repeat-collaboration decision.

Executive decision rule

Scale only when the buying path works, inventory can support demand, creative brings the intended audience, tracking is credible, and estimated contribution economics justify the investment. If one condition fails, fix it before increasing spend.

10 / REFERENCES

Sources, methodology and limitations

Public sources were reviewed for this independent case study. Platform features and regional eligibility change; check the live official help page before execution.

[1] LEGO Ideas - Official LEGO Shop, About LEGO Ideas. Explains fan-submitted product ideas, the 10,000-supporter milestone and review pathway. Accessed 10 October 2026.

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[3] McKinsey & Company, State of the Consumer trends report 2025. Survey results on social media use for product research; findings are market/sample specific.

https://www.mckinsey.com/industries/consumer-packaged-goods/our-insights/state-of-consumer-2025

[4] TikTok for Business, About TikTok Shop and Showcase. Current list of TikTok Shop availability markets and feature description; reviewed October 2026.

https://ads.tiktok.com/resources/help/article/tiktok-shopping-and-showcase?lang=en-GB

[5] LEGO Shop - Official product discovery / shopping taxonomy. Product themes, age and price browse structures visible on official LEGO Shop.

https://www.lego.com/en-us/themes/ideas/about

[6] Meta, “Creators, Short-Form Videos, And Messaging Are Disrupting How Offline Retailers Sell And Scale In India” (2025). Meta-commissioned GWI study and India-specific social discovery claims. Treat as directional and sponsor-linked.

https://about.fb.com/news/2025/06/creators-short-form-videos-and-messaging-are-disrupting-how-offline-retailers-sell-and-scale-in-india/

[7] TikTok for Business, “How to use affiliate creative videos in Video Shopping Ads” (updated March 2026). Describes creator authorization requirements for using affiliate videos in eligible TikTok Shop ads.

https://ads.tiktok.com/resources/help/article/how-to-use-affiliate-creative-videos-in-video-shopping-ads

Methodology

The study combines official LEGO and platform documentation with a third-party consumer-trend report. Facts directly available from sources are described as public facts; market survey statistics are limited to the populations and contexts reported; strategic implications are labeled as recommendations; numerical funnel data is fictional and used only to demonstrate calculation and decision logic.

Limitations

This report does not use LEGO internal campaign analytics, proprietary research, ad account data, retailer conversion logs or confidential creator agreements. Public sources cannot establish causal lift from a specific social activity. Commerce availability, policy and measurement interfaces should be re-checked immediately before implementation. Product margin assumptions in the illustrative model are not LEGO financial disclosures.

THE STRATEGIC TAKEAWAY

Social commerce is an operating system for discovery, proof, purchase and retention - not a collection of shoppable posts.

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